EXPERT, STEP 21

One spreadsheet. Three guardrails.

Can the report still be written if the source stays untouched?

```
# the real run: macOS 27.0.1, Python 3.12.3
Guardrails OFF
Guardrails ON
```

THE JOB

Count the shipment rows and save a report.

THE TEST

Run the same four commands with the guardrails off and on.

EXPERT, STEP 21

Protect the original

The command tried to append a line to a disposable copy of the CSV.

```
# guardrails off
append to CSV: exit 0
CSV unchanged: False
# guardrails on
append to CSV: exit 1
demo: $TMP/shipments.csv: Operation not permitted
CSV unchanged: True
# $TMP: the temporary folder, path shortened
```

GUARDRAILS OFF

The append succeeded.

GUARDRAILS ON

The append failed. The CSV fingerprint stayed the same.

EXPERT, STEP 21

Give it the exact path

A dummy private note sat outside the output folder. The command knew where it was.

```
# guardrails off
read dummy note by exact path: exit 0
dummy note
# guardrails on
read dummy note by exact path: exit 1
cat: $TMP/private-note.txt: Operation not permitted
# $TMP: the temporary folder, path shortened
```

GUARDRAILS OFF

The command read the note.

GUARDRAILS ON

The read failed. This rule protected that note, not the whole Mac.

EXPERT, STEP 21

Test the connection

A harmless endpoint listened on the same Mac. The request carried no shipment data.

```
# guardrails off
request local endpoint: exit 0
endpoint reached
# guardrails on
request local endpoint: exit 7
curl: (7) Failed to connect to 127.0.0.1 port 51482 after
0 ms: Couldn't connect to server
```

GUARDRAILS OFF

The endpoint answered.

GUARDRAILS ON

The request failed. No internet upload was tested.

EXPERT, STEP 21

Keep the useful result

The report still said 198 shipment rows with the guardrails on.

```
# guardrails off
count rows and write report: exit 0
Shipment rows: 198
# guardrails on
count rows and write report: exit 0
Shipment rows: 198
```

TRY IT

Run the demo from the AI Starter Kit on a Mac.

WHAT THIS SHOWS

The commands ran under a policy. No model chose them.